

AT THE TOP
Students at IIM Ahmedabad

TOP 10 B-SCHOOLS OF INDIA

2025	2024	NAME OF THE INSTITUTE	CITY	CATEGORY
1	DNP	INDIAN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT AHMEDABAD	Ahmedabad	Government
2	1	INDIAN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT CALCUTTA	Kolkata	Government
3	2	INDIAN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT LUCKNOW	Lucknow	Government
4	3	S.P. JAIN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT AND RESEARCH	Mumbai	Private
5	5	INDIAN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT INDORE	Indore	Government
6	DNP	XLRI - XAVIER SCHOOL OF MANAGEMENT	Jamshedpur	Private
7	6	MANAGEMENT DEVELOPMENT INSTITUTE GURGAON	Gurugram	Private
8	7	INDIAN INSTITUTE OF FOREIGN TRADE	New Delhi	Government
9	8	SVKM'S NMIMS SCHOOL OF BUSINESS MANAGEMENT	Mumbai	Private
10	9	INDIAN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT SHILLONG	Shillong	Government

DNP: Did not participate

EVERY YEAR, WHEN THE INDIA TODAY BEST B-SCHOOL SURVEY ARRIVES, it performs a small but essential act of national introspection. It asks: what does ambition look like in India today? Where does the country believe managerial talent should come from? And how far will the management-education establishment go to stay relevant in a world being reprogrammed by technology, geopolitics and shifting aspirations?

This year's survey, conducted by market research agency MDRA, is the story of an industry that once prided itself on stability but now faces volatility. It's a story of students who once measured success in salary packages but now read value in flexibility, networks and lifelong relevance.

Across campuses, something fundamental is shifting. Where the Indian MBA was once a monolith—two years of classroom learning, heavy case-based pedagogy and an unyielding hierarchy of institutions—it is now a multi-lane expressway offering divergent routes: full-time programmes for young graduates, online degrees for working professionals, advanced certificates for mid-career executives and doctoral pathways accessible even to senior industry specialists. Management education has moved to becoming a continuum, and India, with more than 4,000 B-schools and the world's youngest workforce, stands at the epicentre of this transformation.

A two-tier system consolidates

If there is an organising principle to the 2025 B-school landscape, it is bifurcation. The sector has split into two distinct tracks: the elite orbit and the crowd below it. At the summit sit the storied giants—public institutions like the IIMs and the best private players like SPJIMR, XLRI, MDI Gurgaon, NMIMS and Symbiosis—whose reputations are now almost as global as they are national. They enjoy sustained recruiter confidence, stable salary outcomes and an alumni network that functions like a self-reinforcing economic system.

This year, the top 10 B-schools maintained an average domestic salary of just over Rs 29 lakh. That figure edged up only marginally, but its significance lies in its stability. Even in a world unsettled by AI-induced job transitions, global supply-chain restructuring, and economic headwinds, India Inc.'s appetite for top-tier managerial talent remains remarkably firm.